

Traditional religion refers to the indigenous belief systems that originated among a people before the introduction of foreign religions such as Christianity or Islam. These religions are passed down orally from generation to generation and are closely tied to the people's culture, customs, and way of life.

Key features of traditional religion:

Belief in a Supreme Being who is the creator of the universe

Worship of lesser gods and spirits, often seen as intermediaries

Veneration of ancestors, who are believed to influence the living

Use of rituals, sacrifices, festivals, and prayers

Strong moral codes that guide behavior and promote harmony

No written holy book; teachings are preserved through stories, proverbs, and practices

Examples:

African Traditional Religion

Native American traditional beliefs

Traditional Asian and Oceanic religions

In Nigeria, traditional religion plays an important role in shaping values, community life, respect for elders, and social order.